

Profile	butter, breakfast bars, muesli, oats, whey protein and plant based protein. These products are in usage across the world, with their protein bars being their best selling items. A 60g protein bar contains approximately 20g of protein and 260 kcal of energy which is derived from various sources, including but not limited to whey, almonds and lentils. These bars are further reinforced with dietary fibre, omega-3 fatty acids, and other minerals to support development and recovery.
Ingredients and Processing	From the company's founding it has emphasised the use of 100% 'natural ingredients', many times including whole wheat, oats, nuts, millets, dates, seeds and honey in their bars. The company prides itself on manufacturing products from artificial flavouring, colors, hydrogenated oils, preservatives and chemicals. This comes at the cost of extended shelf-life, which is often compromised due to the lack of chemicals and preservatives, this highlights the brand's commitment to natural and chemical-free products over profitability.
Taste and Texture	Yoga Bar is mainly based on sweet flavours, like Chocolate Chunk, Peanut Butter, Nuts and Seeds, Cashew Orange, Vanilla Almond, Cardamom, and Coffee. These are flavours which appeal to a broad range of consumers, within India and abroad. As expected, chocolate chunks and coffee are the best-selling flavours. Yoga Bars are known for their soft and crumbly texture, accentuated with natural oils they use for binding and nourishment. This texture often appeals to Indians due to its similarity to chikki, a traditional crumbly peanut and jaggery based sweet that has been eaten for centuries.
Pricing and Affordability	Given the use of quality ingredients and the reduced profitability due to the lack of preservatives, Yoga Bar finds itself in the premium sector of the market, pricing itself completely apart from competitors within India. The value proposition of this product cannot be understated, holding massive appeal to health-conscious consumers, athletes and those undergoing training.
Branding and Positioning	The brand has become just a little short of a status symbol in today's world, becoming endorsed by many celebrities in India. Owing to the brand's premium positioning, the bar has become a staple in the households of India's elite and social media influencers, serving as passive marketing for the company. Additionally, the brand is currently positioned as a 'guilt-free' snacking alternative, embodying the clean eating philosophy and pledging transparency with consumers, a move that catapulted Yoga Bar to new heights. It is at this time the company has developed a cult following of on-the-go snackers, mostly health conscious individuals. Through word of mouth sales, free of cost influencer marketing, and some traditional advertising, the company has encroached into the homes of India's urban households, becoming a staple in grocery stores.
Market Reach	Yoga Bar is currently available (as of April 2025) in over 10,000 retail outlets across India while also being found on major e-commerce platforms like Amazon, Flipkart, BigBasket, and Zepto. Approximately 60% of these sales come from retail stores, as the product is considered an 'impulse purchase'. Its prevalence in retail outlets and massive presence has culminated in the brand observing 100% year-on-year growth, setting the target of becoming a INR 1000 crore brand in the next 2 to 2.5 years.

Strand 4: Develop a detailed design brief

Secondary Research Brief

Every serving of Snacktive must present an optimal balance of macronutrients and indispensable micronutrients to answer the nutritional demand of children 10-14 years old. Preferably, it must carry 10-15g protein, 6-8g of fiber, and 4-6 mg iron to enhance muscle development, promote digestive regularity, and assure proper delivery of oxygen by the body. Moreover, it must contain 100-150 mg of calcium, 5-10mg of zinc, and necessary vitamins such as B-complex, A, C, and D to enhance immunity, eyesight, and general growth. The fat content must be limited to 5g per serving, making it healthy without adding extra calories. The calorie level should be between 250-350 kcal per serving, making it an effective meal substitute or addition without causing undue weight. To maximize nutrition without exceeding calories, high-fiber, high-protein foods like legumes, seeds, and whole grains must come first while excluding excessive sugar or bad fats. The core of the snack must consist of millets (ragi, bajra), chickpeas, lentils, black beans, oats, or quinoa, all contributing sustained energy, protein, and fiber. Nutrient-dense fruits and vegetables like dates (iron), bananas (potassium), carrots (vitamin A), spinach (iron and folate), sweet potatoes (beta-carotene), and pumpkin seeds (zinc and magnesium) can be added to improve micronutrient content. Children in this age group enjoy appealing flavors such as sweet cinnamon, chocolate, vanilla, honey, peanut butter, mixed berries, and mango,

and also savory ones like BBQ, garlic parmesan, masala, and chaat-flavored ones that appeal to Indian palates. Natural sweeteners like dates, jaggery, or honey can be used instead of refined sugar, providing necessary minerals while adding flavor.

To preserve nutrition with minimum fat consumption, the most appropriate cooking techniques would be baking, air-drying, or roasting since deep-frying incorporates excess fats and boiling can destroy water-soluble vitamins. For stability on the shelf, natural preservatives like vitamin C (ascorbic acid), vitamin E (tocopherols), rosemary extract, or citric acid can safely prolong shelf life. In case preservatives are not to be used, vacuum-sealing and nitrogen flushing in tightly sealed, moisture-proof, oxygen-limited packages can preserve freshness naturally without additives.

Primary Research Brief

For Indian children between the ages of 10-14, the best macronutrient composition should be about 50-55% carbohydrates, 20-25% protein, and 20-25% good fats for growth and energy requirements. For better iron absorption of black beans and spinach, complementing them with vitamin C-containing foods such as citrus fruits or bell peppers works well, while keeping calcium-rich foods away simultaneously can increase uptake. Air-drying or baking is the optimum cooking method as it preserves vital nutrients while keeping the fat content at a minimum. Anti-nutrients such as phytates in millets and oxalates in spinach may be minimized through soaking, fermentation, or sprouting prior to preparation. To keep Snackive as healthy as it is tasty, employing natural flavor enhancers such as cinnamon, jaggery, and herbs rather than artificial additives, as well as playful textures (chewy or crunchy), can make it more desirable for children while still having a high-protein, high-fiber, and micronutrient-dense profile.

Brief of Market Research (existing products)

The Indian health food market is growing day by day, but nevertheless, there remains a large sector that has been left untapped by many - the savoury health snack market. This market has been left untapped mainly due to the prevalence of existing snacking options like potato chips, cheese balls, and other options which are often enjoyed by children. These industries have become completely targeted towards the health conscious consumers of India, the athletes and often the fitness enthusiasts. Due to this targeted development, adolescent consumers have been ignored completely, opening a vital market space which needs more players. The existing market options often include sweet options, which make up whole brands in many cases, like MaxProtein, Yoga Bar and Nourish Organics. That leaves only 1 player in the savoury healthy snack space, Snackible, which is able to attract a great deal of attention through innovative flavours and combinations but still fails in exciting the average adolescent consumer. The use of millets, combined with lackluster marketing and package design has pushed this brand to cater mainly to the elderly population of India. Another observed trend within the Indian health market is the tendency to favour clean-eating options, this involves reducing or removing the amount of preservatives, artificial color and flavour, pesticides and fertilizers from their supply chain and manufacturing processes. This trend, kickstarted by Yoga Bar in 2014 has gained wide-spread following, and these labels are something that every Indian consumer looks for prior to purchasing a product. Many brands which do not list such features on their packages find themselves losing a large portion of their consumer market simply because they have not made the tag prominent.

Important Insights and Patterns Identified (*Summary of Research Brief*)

Both forms of research conducted highlight the importance of:-

- A balanced ratio of carbohydrates, proteins, and fats to ensure sustained energy and support growth in the target age group.
- Vitamin C in aiding iron absorption from ingredients like black beans and spinach.
- Baking or Air-Frying while cooking the product to reduce fat quantity and preserve nutrients.
- Reducing the amount of Anti-Nutrients like phytates and oxalates by soaking, fermenting or sprouting millets and spinach.
- Using natural flavorings in the seasoning blends to minimise the introduction of unwanted chemicals. This would involve the usage of cinnamon, jaggery and herbs to provide flavour while bringing their own health benefits to the snack.

- Legumes, whole grains, seeds and black beans in maximising the amount of protein and fibre in the snack.

Product Brief

Snacking is the favourite pastime of the human population, something every single person engages in, and an opportunity to provide much-needed nutrition that hasn't been exploited as yet. The ideal delivery mechanism of these benchmarks would be a simple snack - something that can be eaten at any time of the day, at work or at home, during commutes as well. It must also be noted that the 21st century has been defined by unparalleled scientific and technical innovation, something that must now transfer to the food industry. The food industry must not begin the process of adaptation to the new ways of life, seeking to ensure their consumers' welfare whilst benefiting from the sales of new products. Through the usage and optimization of existing food technologies, and the development of new, more creative ways of providing flavour, the food industry can become a beacon of healthy practices, shaping the wellbeing of all their consumers. This can very easily be done by creating a snacking solution with the following benchmarks and features:-

Nutrition

- Macronutrient Ratio: ~50-55% carbohydrates, 20-25% protein, 20-25% healthy fats
- High in Protein: 10-15g per serving
- Rich in Fiber: 6-8g per serving
- Low in Calories: 250-350 kcal per serving
- Low in Fat: Maximum of 5g per serving
- Iron: 4-6mg per serving, with vitamin C for better absorption
- Calcium: 100-150mg per serving
- Zinc: 5-10mg per serving
- Vitamins: B-complex, A, C, and D

Key Features

- Base Ingredients: Millets (ragi, bajra), chickpeas, lentils, black beans, oats, quinoa
- Savory Flavors: BBQ, garlic parmesan, masala, chaat
- Natural Sweeteners: Dates, jaggery, honey
- No Artificial Preservatives or Additives
- Natural Preservatives: Vitamin C (ascorbic acid), vitamin E (tocopherols), rosemary extract, citric acid
- Alternative Storage: Vacuum-sealing and nitrogen flushing in airtight, moisture-proof packaging
- Anti-Nutrients Reduced: Soaking, fermenting, or sprouting to minimize phytates and oxalate
- Baked, Air-Fried, Roasted

It is essential that the product features a bright colour scheme, differentiating itself from the other snacks found in regular supermarkets in order to captivate the attention of the target audience. To further hone in the solution's ability to cater to the target group, it must be available in four different flavours, each attracting a different sector of the group. Reusable packaging would be key to attracting first-time consumers as it grants them the opportunity to consume the snack over a period of time, rather than in one sitting, something first-time consumers are unlikely to do.

Criterion B: Developing Ideas

Strand 1: Developing design specifications

Design Specifications	Justification	Testing Method
Aesthetics		
Branding - Clean, modern and minimalistic	Branding A clean, modern and minimalistic aesthetic	Customer Surveys Targeted questionnaires